



Mr. Oliver P. Hoffmaster Jr.  
415 ~~avenue~~  
St. Louis (1-6)  
Mo.

April 4<sup>th</sup>

Sweetheart

A million things flash before me as I sit here, lonely, trying to give you a little news.

Mother called a lady - a member of our church. whose son was recently discharged from the Marines to find out how long it took him to come from Bago - and she said he got home in a little over a week - and here it is almost two weeks and we don't have any news yet. It's about to drive me nuts. I've got so darn much on my mind - if I only knew when he was coming. I'm supposed to be on duty at the hospital the 11<sup>th</sup> and even with that much effension I don't know whether or not I'll get to see him this time. I told mother this morning that if I had known it was going to be this long. I'd have come back to St. Louis and come home one weekend soon. I'd really be ahead in the long run. So it is I've already lost \$20.00 and that would be enough for a trip home and extra, too. I suppose I worry too much, but I always did worry a lot. &

Now I'm worried about three things - finances - getting back to St. Louis and my mother. You're there's State Board hanging over my head like a storm cloud. Maybe I just don't live right - but now I'm so down in the dumps I could die. Is there a solution? I sometimes wonder.

I got a letter from Dordie and Annie this morning. (Two

of my class mates) and they're both doing period duty getting \$7.00 a day and it just kills me sitting there doing nothing. Insie is working the gear yard shift but Dordie got a break and is on days. But Insie says it's all right with her because it's quiet where she lives and she gets a lot of sleep.

The two boys next door came home - they're both discharged - One of them is married and the other one just got engaged two days ago. This a student nurse in Philadelphia and he met her while he was in the Army. Well, to get on with my story - Mary Ann and I were over there last night playing cards with them. Those jerks used to bat me around like a rubber ball when I was in school. I just can't see them getting married, they're both so juvenile. In fact the one that's married is so dumb - they're only been married three months and she's already pregnant. She came over last week one day and asked me to tell her about birth control. She said she wasn't ready to start her family yet - but didn't know how to prevent it. People seem to get the idea that nurses know all about that and when it comes right down to brass tacks we don't know any more about it than the ordinary person. But we don't learn those things in training.

Well - that's enough of that - now about you -



11

You know something, huh? I wish you like the devil. Darling, I've searched the dictionaries for words to describe the greatness I feel for you. How much I love you. How it keeps on growing from day today - how very much I miss you. How long the days seem without you near me - My sweet, every day away from you is a little eternity that seems to intensify as each empty day slips by. Those constant little reminders that pluck at your heart strings - play a melody every time there's a letter in the mail box from you that creep into every day life. I've never missed you quite this much before - never loved you the way I do now. I never realized before just how love can affect a person. I go to movies here - sure it takes up time - but the emptiness that follows is insupportable. I feel so darn lonely for your company. Before - we were two people living two separate lives - now we're one person living two lives. It's love that strips off the capsule of cold reality and cloaks it with a velvety warmth of beautiful optimism. It's like looking at the world through rose colored glasses.

Mary Ann is going out with some kids tonight. She asked me to go along - but they are going to have

dates - so of course that is out. I didn't want to go out any way.

I went over to my aunt's house yesterday and kept the doctor as a treatment on her. I wore my uniform and felt in the groove again.

I've just written 7 letters today to the kids I'm around with. By this time they're scattered all over the U. S.

Mother just gave me the pleasant news that I'm getting fat again - ugh - and after all that work losing those 15 lbs. It's quite discouraging.

I'm on my stomach on the floor again and as sleepy as the dickens. Three more gaps and I'll be gone.

So long for now and remember that you are the object of all my dreams.

Eternally yours,  
Martha